

ANTIQUE LACE WEDDING DRESS

There was a vogue for ballerina-length wedding dresses in the mid- to late 1950s, often made of or incorporating lace. This dress, created for an English wedding in 1960, shows an evolution in style from one fashion icon to the next. In the heady optimism of the 1950s, Grace Kelly-style dresses like this one – with tiny waists, luxurious full skirts, and copious lace – were copied widely. Lace production stopped during World War II, and afterwards it was sought after obsessively. The neat tailoring reflects the style of an emerging fashion icon, Jacqueline Kennedy, who became the US first lady in 1960. Made of heavy ivory silk, the gown was designed by Christina Ciapella working with the bride, Margaret Carter. Ivory was a sophisticated colour choice in the 1960s, and the scooped neckline showcases the antique lace collar.

▷ ACCESSORIES

The bride's accessories included cream leather shoes and a tiny brown feather hat with a veil.



VEIL



SHOES



SIDE VIEW

Skirt falls in heavy, unpressed box pleats

Stiffened collar

Lace was often removed from an earlier garment and incorporated into a wedding dress because it was an heirloom or, as here, a gift to the bride

Darts at the elbow narrow and shape the lower sleeve

Three-quarter-length sleeves with lace-trimmed "wedding points"

Waist sits just below natural waistline

